HOOK

Your AI agent shipped 10x more code this month

Did your team ship 10x more working software?
Probably not.

WHAT'S HAPPENING

Code volume is up. Shippable software isn't

Coding agents are converging on the same gap right now

- Teams adopting agents report faster code generation
- Maintained, production-ready output isn't keeping pace
- The bottleneck moved from typing to judgment
- This gap is why agents can feel 'dumb' in practice

WHY THIS HAPPENS

Agents optimize for output, not outcomes

They generate plausible code, not validated systems

- An agent's goal is 'produce code that compiles'
- Your goal is 'produce code that works in production'
- Nobody told the agent those are different goals
- Volume became an easy, misleading proxy for progress

THE MECHANISM

Where the gap actually gets created

It's not one bug. It's a missing layer of discipline

- No clear spec means the agent guesses at intent
- No tests mean nobody catches the wrong guess
- No review process means errors compound silently
- No architecture constraints mean sprawl, not structure

THE FIX

Treat the agent like a fast junior engineer

Fast juniors still need direction, review, and guardrails

- Write the spec before you prompt, not after
- Define tests or acceptance criteria up front
- Review diffs the way you'd review a PR
- Keep a human owning architecture decisions

WHAT CHANGES

Engineering discipline becomes the differentiator

The agent isn't the bottleneck. Your process is

- Error handling and retry logic still need a human eye
- Maintainability still has to be designed, not generated
- Validation steps matter more as generation gets cheaper
- The teams that win add process, not just prompts

TAKEAWAY

Measure shipped software, not lines generated

If output is rising faster than shipped work, you have a gap

- Track what reaches production, not what gets drafted
- Audit one agent-built feature for test coverage this week
- Add a review checkpoint before merge, not after

CTA

What's your agent actually shipping?

Curious how this plays out in your workflow

- Tell me where the gap shows up for your team